

3 File management

of the detailed view in the explorer in windows and the Cover flow is a more visually appealing way of browsing through your media.

3.Quick Look: This gives an instant preview of the selected item

4.Proxy Icon: By dragging this onto an empty area you can create a copy/shortcut of the folder currently open depending on whether you are pressing the option key or not.

5.Action Menu: Context specific menu, equivalent of right clicking on the selected icon.

6.Search: This is another spotlight front end integrated into the finder window, but won't include WebPages and mail in the result.

7.Hides or shows the Sidebar or the toolbar, returning a very concise view.

SideBar in Finder

With more widescreens [courtesy the omnipresent laptops] sidebars play an important role in giving access to frequently used content in a non obtrusive yet quick way. The sidebar is divided into four categories:

FinderSidebar: The various quick launch features of the sidebar

1.Devices: You plug in your pen drive it shows over here, you connect your iPod it shows over here and same when you pop in your favorite mixed cd. All the external media is stored over here. Each device has a eject icon next to it, which acts like the "safely remove feature".

2.Shared: Any shared device which your computer can access irrespective of whether connected via Bonjour, Time Capsule and so on will be present over here.

3.Places: If you feel constricted by the choices available by the default folder in the Home folder you can expand your choice over here.

4.Search For: These are a bunch of smart folders which contain useful searches for every day needs, For example files created/modified in the last day or week. Similarly there is one for showing all the movies or documents.

Remember you can rearrange these four in whichever order you want by the mere act of drag and drop. Performing Common Task in Finder

3.1.2 The dock

A definite distinguishing feature of the Mac UI, your Dock is your quick launch bar and taskbar rolled into one. It even has shortcuts for frequently used programs, folders and documents. We will study the preferences associated with Dock [in the System Preference section] a little later down,